wine 'n' english
Wine
Glossary

Quem **somos?**

Wine 'n' English é um projeto criado pela escola de idiomas **Twice Languages** e pela empresa de vinhos **Claudia Melo Wines**.

Temos como objetivo aprimorar o seu inglês da maneira mais divertida possível: degustando vinhos. Não há jeito melhor que esse para estudar!

Nossos workshops se dividem em:

1) Básico de vinhos: para aqueles que amam a bebida de Baco e gostariam de aprender um pouco mais.

2) Técnicos: para quem quer se aprimorar tecnicamente na área de vinhos. Funciona tanto para empresas como para grupos de amigos que curtem se aprofundar no tema.

Oferecemos workshops presenciais em todas as cidades do Brasil. E também cursos online, com vinhos presenciais! Afinal, vinho é parte essencial da sua aprendizagem.

TWICE LANGUAGES

CLAUDIA MELO *Wines*

wine ‘n’ English

A Wine’n’English tem como missão torná-lo um expert bilíngue em vinhos.

Além dos nossos conteúdos presenciais e online, desenvolvemos esse **Wine Glossary** para te ajudar nos primeiros passos, quando quiser entender sobre algum termo relacionado ao mundo do vinho.

Como acontece em toda área de conhecimento, um tema pode acabar ficando muito técnico e difícil de entender. E com isso, acabamos desistindo de seguir em frente.

Por isso estamos aqui e fizemos este **e-book**. Para te dar uma ajuda, de maneira **fácil, rápida e prática**, quando surgir aquela dúvida sobre algumas das **principais expressões** relacionadas ao vinho.

Vamos lá?! Esperamos que esse e-book lhe auxilie na sua caminhada do conhecimento.

Cheers!

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Wine 'n' English

ABV: The abbreviation of alcohol by volume, listed as percentage on a wine label (e.g., 13.5% ABV)

Acidity: A naturally occurring component of every wine. This component makes a wine feel fresh, or give it lift. Too much acidity makes a wine taste sour and feel sharp. Not enough acidity will make a wine feel flabby.

Aeration: The process of introducing oxygen to wine (aka breathing). This helps the wine to release its aromas. It also helps to round and soften the wine and to reduce its alcohol perception. Decanting is one of the methods used to allow sufficient air contact.

Aggressive: An aggressive wine is usually very high in acidity. The term can also be used to describe wines with hard tannins.

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Alcohol: The end product of fermentation; technically ethyl alcohol resulting from the interaction of natural grape sugars and yeast; generally above 12.5 percent in dry table wines.

AOP: Appellation d'Origine Protegée, a French term for Designation of Origin. *See Appellation*. Until a few years ago, it was written AOC (Appellation d'Origine Controlée)

Appellation: A legally defined geographical location used to identify where (and how) grapes are grown and made into wine.

Aroma: Aroma is used to describe the scent of a wine; i.e. fruity, vegetal, spicy. Aroma compounds are derived from grapes and fermentation and are volatilized by the evaporation of alcohol.

Aroma wheel: A tool that helps individuals to categorize the aromas perceived when smelling or when tasting wine. (See picture)

Assemblage: French term for the grape varieties used to blend a wine.

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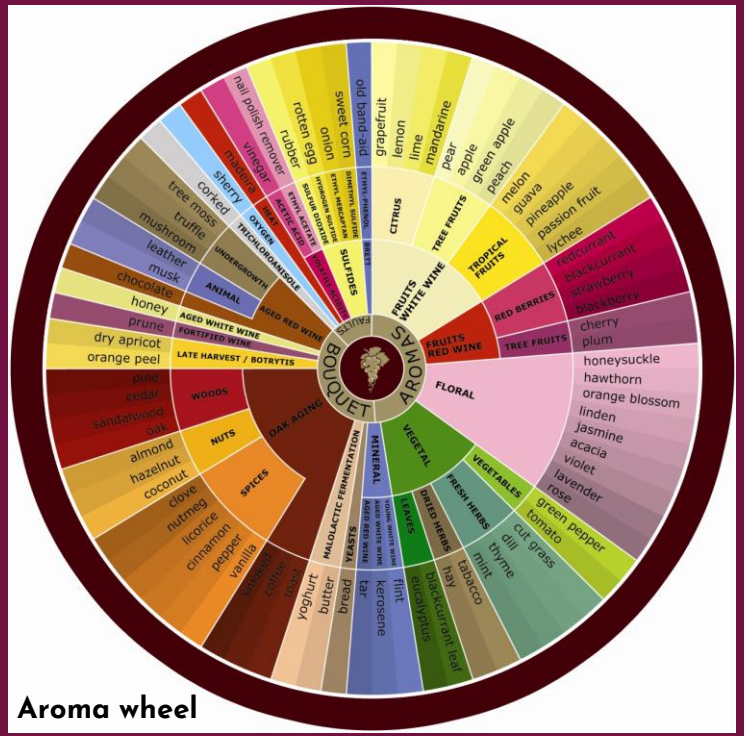
Azienda Agricola: An Italian wine term for an estate winery (a winery with vineyards).

Astringent: A drying mouthfeel typically caused by tannins, which bind to salivary proteins, causing them to depart the tongue/mouth. It results in a rough sandpapery sensation in the mouth. Example: when tasting wine, notice if you feel a dry-mouth sensation.



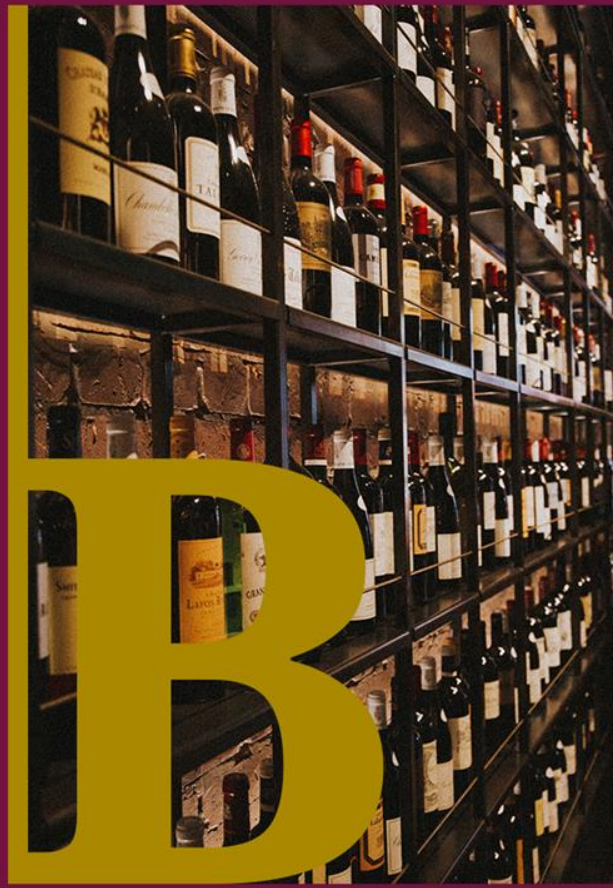
Aroma wheel

Bacchus: The Roman God of wine, known as Dionysus in ancient Greece. Also, a hybrid white grape from Germany.

Balance: The level of harmony between acidity, tannins, fruit, oak, and other elements in a wine; a perceived quality that is more individual than scientific.

Balthazar: A 12-liter wine bottle. It is equivalent to 16 standard bottles.

Barrel Fermented: A process by which wine (usually white) is fermented in oak barrels rather than in stainless steel tanks; a richer, creamier, oakier style of wine.



Biodynamic: Homeopathic manner of farming that uses natural composts, or preparations, and times farming work with celestial cycles. It was popularized in the 1920s by the Austrian philosopher Rudolf Steiner. Certified biodynamic wines contain very limited amount of sulfites and do not necessarily taste differently than non-biodynamic wines.

Blanc de Blancs: The name for sparkling wines made entirely from white grapes.

Blanc de Noirs: The name for sparkling wines made entirely from red grapes.

Blend: The process whereby two or more grape varieties are combined after separate fermentation. Wine made from more than one grape variety. Also referred to *Assemblage*, french term used for the same process. Opposite to Varietal.

Bodega: Spanish word for winery or cellar.

Body: The impression of weight on one's palate; light, medium, and full are common body qualifiers.

Bold: Red wine with dark color, high alcohol, with concentration and intensity.

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Bouquet: The sum of the aromas of the wine; how a wine smells as a whole.

Breathe: The process of letting a wine open up via the introduction of air. Normally a decanter is used in this process.

Brut: A French term used to describe a dry sparkling wine.

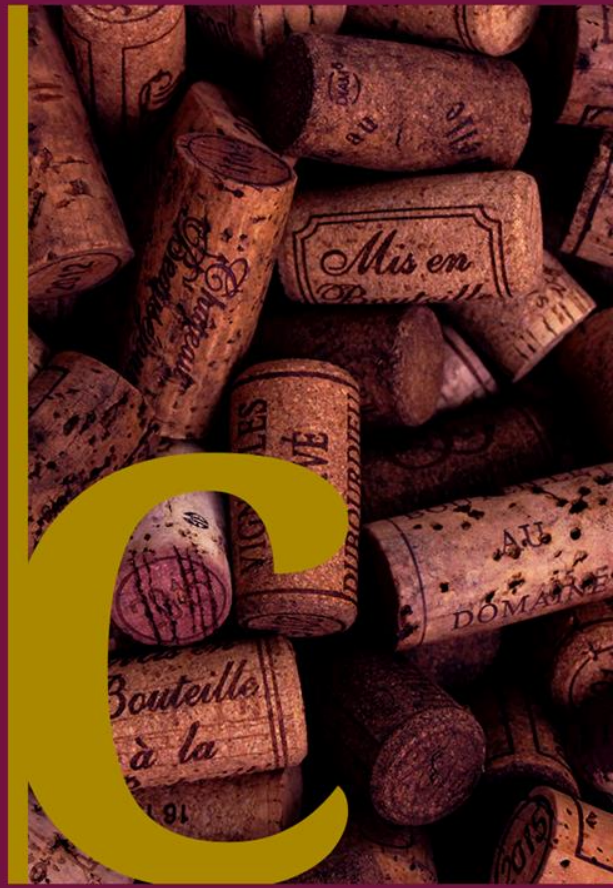
Brut Champagne

Carbonic Maceration: A winemaking method where uncrushed grapes are placed in a sealed vat and topped with carbon dioxide.
Wines created without oxygen have low tannin, light color with fruit flavors and aromas. This practice is common with entry-level Beaujolais wines.

Cava: Spanish sparkling wine made in the traditional Champagne style originally from Xarel-lo, Macabeo, and Parellada grapes. Today the use of Chardonnay is permitted.

Champagne: A denominated region in the northeast of Paris in which Chardonnay, Pinot Noir, and Pinot Meunier grapes are made into sparkling wine. Only the sparkling wines coming from this region and made in the traditional method can be named Champagne.

Château: French word for castle, often used to refer to a winery in France.



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Cheers: Expressing good wishes before drinking, as we raise our glasses.

Chianti: A scenic, hilly region of Tuscany known for red wines made mostly from Sangiovese grapes.

Clarification: A process after fermentation where proteins and dead yeast cells are removed. Main ways of induce clarification: fining, filtration, centrifugation and refrigeration.

Color: Besides a wine style (white, rosé and red), color is a key determinant of a wine's age and quality. White wines grow darker in color as they age, while red wines turn brownish orange.

Corked: A wine with musty, mushroomy aromas and flavors resulting from a cork tainted by TCA (trichloroanisol). It is considered a fault.

Corkscrew: Device for pulling corks from bottles. It normally consists of a spiral metal rod that is inserted into the cork, and a handle that extracts it, although there are many different types of corkscrew.

Crianza: A Spanish term for a red wine that has been aged in oak barrels for at least one year.

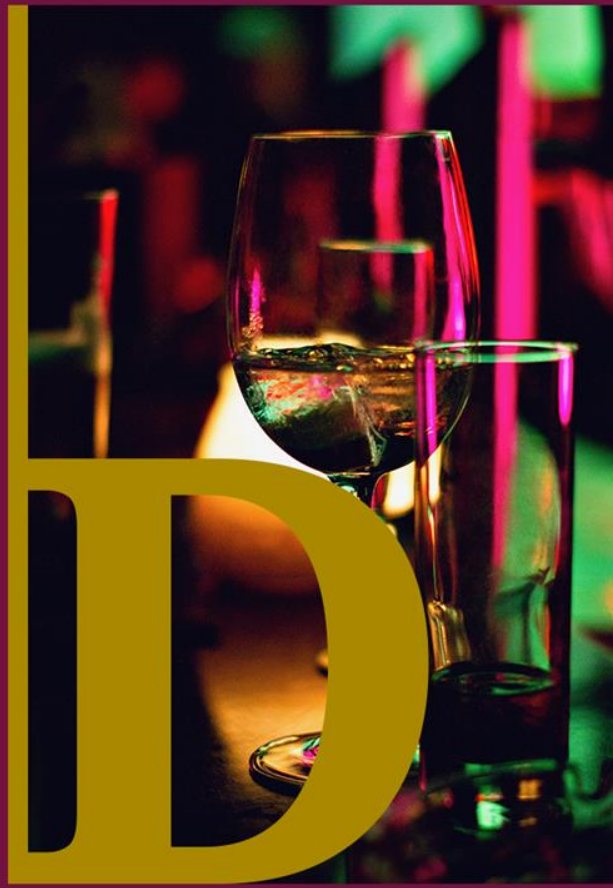
Cru: French term for growth or vineyard that is often used for Classified wines, i.e. cru bourgeois, cru classe, premier cru, and grand cru.

Decant: The process of transferring wine from a bottle to another holding vessel in order to remove the solid particles (sediments) that may be present in the wine bottle. Most people misuse the term to refer to aeration (See aeration)

Denominación de Origen: Spanish for 'appellation of origin;' like the French AOP or Italian DOC.

Dionysus: Or Dionysos is the god of the grape-harvest, winemaking, and wine in ancient Greek religion and myth. In Rome, known as Bacchus.

Disgorge: The process by which final sediments are removed from traditionally made sparkling wines prior to the adding of the dosage and the final cork.



DOC: Denominazione di Origine Controllata, Italian for 'appellation of origin'. Same as AOP in France.

DOCG: Denominazione di Origine Controllata e Garantita is the highest designation of quality among Italian wines and stands for 'guaranteed appellation of origin'.

Dosage: A sweetened spirit added at the very end to Champagne and other traditionally made sparkling wines. It determines whether a wine is extra brut, brut, extra dry, dry, or sweet.

Double Magnum: A 3-liter wine bottle. It is equivalent to 4 standard bottles.

Douro: A river in Portugal as well as the wine region famous for producing Port wines.

Doux: French word for sweet. A sweet wine.

Dry: Wines where most all the grape sugar has been fermented. In Brazil, a wine containing no more than 4g/l of residual (unfermented) sugar.

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Enology: The science of wine production; an enologist is a professional winemaker

Enophile: Also spelled oenophile. A person who enjoys wine, who is a wine enthusiast.

Enophobia: Also spelled oenophobia. The fear of wine.

Fermentation: The process by which yeasts interact with grape juice converting sugar into alcohol.

Filtration: The process by which wine is clarified before bottling, using a filter to remove large particles.

Fining: Part of the clarification process whereby fining agents are used to remove unwanted solid material from the wine, i.e. egg whites, milk casein or bentonite.

Finish: Finish can refer to the aftertaste, to how long the flavors last until they fade, and also to the textural impact.

Flavors: The sensory impression of the taste of a wine, through the combination of the two senses: taste and smell. As with aromas, main flavors can be categorized as fruity, floral, spicy, vegetal or oaky.

Flaws: Fault or defect in wine, generating unpleasant characteristics often resulting from poor winemaking practices or storage conditions, and leading to wine spoilage.

Fortified Wine: A wine in which grape brandy is introduced during fermentation. Alcohol stops the fermentation process, resulting in a sweet and fortified wine.

Frizzante: An Italian term for a lightly sparkling wine.

Fortified wines

Wine before and after **fining**

Gran Reserva: A Spanish term used for wines that are aged in wood and bottles for at least five years prior to release. Most used in Rioja region.

Grand Cru: French for 'great growth;' the very best vineyards.

Grape varietal: See *Varietal*

Grapevine: A vine bearing grapes used for eating or winemaking

Hectoliter: A metric measure equal to 100 liters or 26.4 gallons.

Herbaceous: An aroma or flavor similar to green; often an indication of underripe grapes or grapes grown in a cool climate.

Ice Wine: From the German *Eiswein*, this is low alcohol sweet wine made from frozen grapes.

Imperial: A 6-liter wine bottle. It is equivalent to 8 standard bottles (aka *Methuselah*).

Intensity: The concentration of color and aroma in a wine, which can be described as low, medium or high.

Jeroboam: A 4.5-liter still wine bottle. It is equivalent to 6 standard bottles

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Kosher: A wine made according to strict Jewish rules under rabbinical supervision.

Late Harvest: A term used to describe dessert wines made from over ripen grapes left on the vines for an extra-long period. It results in a naturally sweet and high acid wine.

Lees: Sediment from dead yeast left in wine after the fermentation. Lees stirring or, as they say in French, "sur lie" can add a richer body and creaminess to wine.

Maceration: Time during vinification when the grapes, seeds, skins and pulp allow their materials to be extracted, adding color, Flavor and tannins to the wine.

Madeira: A fortified wine that has been made on the Portuguese Madeira island since the fifteenth century.

Magnum: A 1.5-liter wine bottle. It is equivalent to 2 standard bottles.

Malolactic Fermentation (MLF): Not technically a fermentation but a bacteria called *Oenococcus oeni* that converts one type of acid (malic acid) to another type of acid (lactic acid). MLF makes wine taste smoother and creamier. Nearly all red wines and some white wines, like Chardonnay, go through MLF.

Melchoir: An 18-liter wine bottle. It is equivalent to 24 standard bottles (aka *Solomon*).

Methuselah: A 6 liter-wine bottle. It is equivalent to 8 standard bottles (aka *Imperial*).

Minerality: A non-scientific term used to describe flavors that smell or taste like rocks or organic matter (soil). Some of the descriptors are chalky, flinty or aroma of wet cement.

Mouth-Feel: The textural sensation that takes place in the mouth when drinking wine. Examples of mouth-feel descriptors: smooth, velvet, soft, astringent, thick, flat, flabby

Must: Freshly pressed grape juice that still contains the seeds, stems, and skins of a grape.

Standard vs **Magnum** bottles

Natural Wine: A generalized term used to describe wines that are produced with sustainable, organic, and/or biodynamic viticulture. Wines are processed using minimal or no additives. There is no regulation with regards to natural wine.

Nebuchadnezzar: A 15-liter wine bottle. It is equivalent to 20 standard bottles.

Noble Rot: Noble rot is a fungal infection caused by *Botrytis cinerea*, common in areas with high humidity, which dries the grapes, increasing the sugar concentration in each berry. It is considered a flaw in red grapes but appreciated in white grapes. Infected grapes make a natural sweet wine with flavors of honey, ginger, marmalade, and chamomile. Dessert wines from Sauternes and Tokaj regions are made through noble rot.

Nose: A wine tasting term used to describe how wine smells in the glass. Different wines will produce different aromas. (See Aroma)

Oak: American white oak (*Quercus alba*) is primarily used in the Bourbon industry. American oak is known for adding flavors of coconut, vanilla, cedar, and dill to the wine. European oak (*Quercus robur*) is sourced primarily in France and Hungary. European oak is known for adding flavors of vanilla, clove, allspice, and cedar to the wine.

Oaked: A term used to describe a wine that aged in oak barrel for a certain period. Opposite: unoaked.

Oaky: A term used to describe woody aromas and flavors; butter, popcorn, and toast notes are found in 'oaky' wines.

Off-Dry: A term to describe a wine that is slightly sweet. In Brazil, a wine containing between 4 and 25g/ of residual (unfermented) sugar

Orange Wine: A term used to describe a style of white wine where the grape must is fermented with the skins and the seeds, much like a red wine. This fermentation process dyes the wine a deeper orange color. It is a very old style of producing white wines.

Organic: Grapes grown without the aid of chemical-based fertilizers, pesticides, or herbicides. Organic wines are made with organic grapes.

Oxidized: A wine that is no longer fresh because it was exposed to too much air. When wine is exposed to oxygen, a chain of chemical reactions occur that alter the compounds, modifying the wine aromas, taste and color. In case of red wine, color changes to slightly brown, it shows no fruity aromas and displays some notes of vinegar.

Regular vs **oxidized** red wine

Pétillant: A French term for sparkling wine bubbles. Slightly sparkling wine.

pH: An indication of a wine's acidity expressed by how much hydrogen is in it. Wine pH scale goes from 2.5 (sweet wine, which has high acidity) up to 4.5 (low acid red wines).

Phylloxera: A microscopic louse that eats *Vitis vinifera* roots and kills vines. It was responsible for devastating the majority of the world's vineyards in the nineteenth century.

Port Wine: A sweet, fortified wine made in the Douro Valley, Portugal. Port styles include Ruby, Tawny, Vintage, Late Bottled Vintage, White and Rosé.

Press: The process by which grape juice is extracted; a machine that extracts juice from grapes.

Primary aromas: When made into wine, each grape variety offers a unique set of aromas called primary aromas. These aromas are typically fruit, herb and flower smells and come naturally just from the grape. See also secondary and tertiary aromas.

Prosecco: Sparkling wine that originates from the Veneto region in Italy. The wine is made with Prosecco grapes (also called "Glera") and using a different method of the Champagne production.

Pruning: Done to reduce yields in the winter, pruning involves the cutting and removal of different parts of the vines.

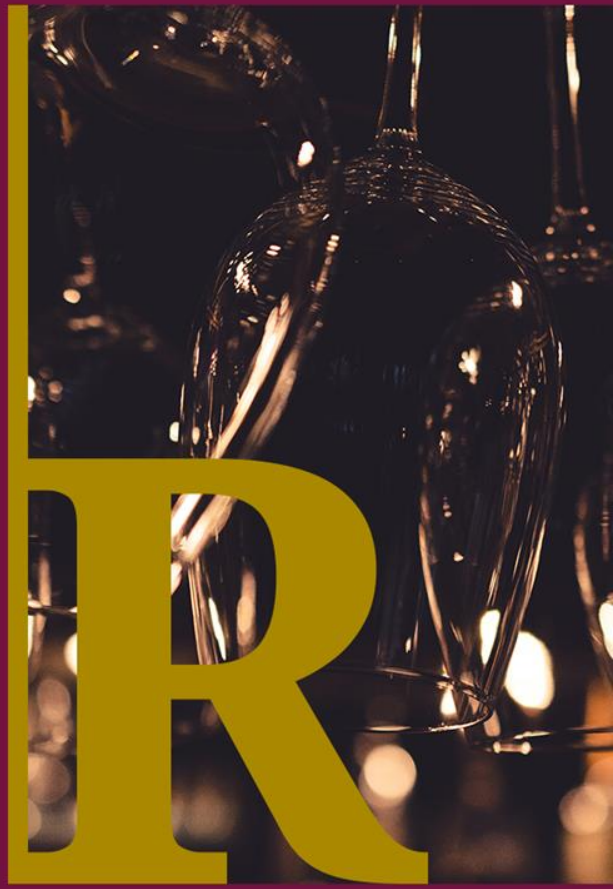
Vertical wine **press**

Racking: The process of moving wine from barrel to barrel, while leaving sediments behind.

Reduction: When wine doesn’t receive enough air during fermentation, the yeast will substitute its need of nitrogen with amino acids (found in grapes). This creates sulfur compounds that can smell like rotten eggs, garlic, burnt matches. It is the opposite of oxidation.

Reserva: A Spanish wine term that is used to describe a wine that has been aged for longer than the standard denomination. Aging varies from region to region.

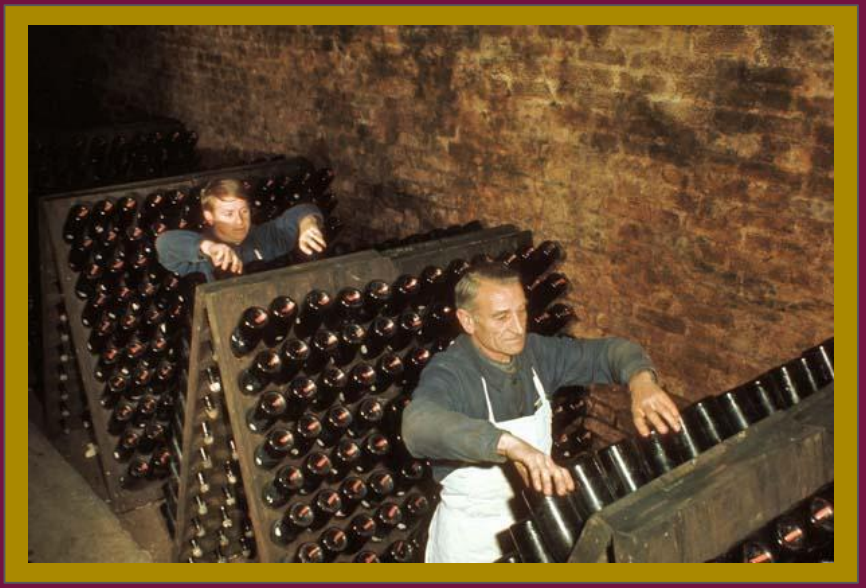
Reserve: A largely American term indicating a wine of higher quality; it has no legal meaning.



Residual Sugar (RS): The unfermented sugar from grapes left over in a wine after a fermentation stops. Residual Sugar ranges from nothing to upward of 400 grams per liter for very natural sweet wines.

Riddling: The process of rotating sparkling wine bottles in order to shift sediment toward the cork.

Ripe: A ripe wine is one that is produced when its grapes have reached the optimum level of maturity.



Riddling

Salmanazar: A 9-liter wine bottle. It is equivalent to 12 standard bottles.

Sauternes: A sweet white wine made from botrytized grapes (affected by noble rot) of Semillon and Sauvignon Blanc, coming from the French region with same name.

Screwcap: A metal cap that screws onto threads on the neck of a bottle, generally with a metal skirt down the neck to resemble the traditional wine capsule.

Secondary Aromas: The process of fermentation creates a specific group of bouquets, the secondary aromas. Examples are bread, butter, mushroom and yeasts.

Sediments: Solid material that settles to the bottom of a wine bottle. It is normal to occur with non-clarified wines. Sediment will not harm you and are not a signal of spoiled wine. When a wine contains sediments it is described as dull. If there are no sediments, it is described as clear.

Sediments in a glass

Sherry: A fortified wine from a denominated region in southwest Spain (Jerez de la Frontera). Sherry styles include Fino, Manzanilla, Oloroso, Amontillado and PX. (aka Jerez)

Solomon: An 18-liter wine bottle. It is equivalent to 24 standard bottles (aka *Melchoir*).

Sommelier: Specialist in all aspects of the wine service.

Spicy: Aroma or flavor of spice that may be present in a wine glass. It is more often associated with red wines and adds a warming effect to the drink. Common spicy aromas are black pepper, cinnamon, clove, nutmeg, aniseed or ginger

Sparkling wine: Wine style characterized by effervescence due to high levels of carbon dioxide. Wine with bubbles (or pétillance, in French).

Still wine: Wine without any carbon dioxide making it still, not bubbly, sparkling or fizzy. Opposite of sparkling wine.

Sulfites: Sulfites, sulfur dioxide, or SO2 is a preservative that is either added to wine or present on grapes before fermentation. Wines range from about 10 ppm (parts per million) to 350ppm. Wines must label if they contain more than 10 ppm.

Sweet: A wine with more than 25g/l of residual (unfermented) sugar. The opposite of dry wine.

Screwcap

Table Wine: A term used to describe wines of between 10 and 14 percent alcohol. It does not denote quality.
In Europe, table wines are those made outside of regulated regions or by unapproved methods. In Brazil, it refers to wines produced with non-European grapes, coming from non-*Vitis vinifera* vines, such as Bordô, Concord or Niagara.

Tank: A vessel for fermentation that is most often made of stainless steel, concrete or oak. This is the same as a vat.

Tannins: Phenolic compounds that exist in most plants; in grapes, tannins are found primarily in the skins and seeds. Tannins are astringent, provide structure to a wine and are also antioxidants agents.

Terroir: A French term for the combination of soil, climate, aspect and all the other factors that influence the ultimate character of a wine.

Tertiary Aromas: Process of aging wine adds aromas (bouquet) compounds in wine, known as tertiary aromas. They are non fruit aromatics like truffles, tobacco, leather, tar, nuts and spice.

Tokaji: A dessert wine made in Tokaj, Hungary from dried Furmint grapes affected by noble rot.

Tokaj region

Varietal: A wine made from just one grape type and named after that grape; the opposite of a blend.

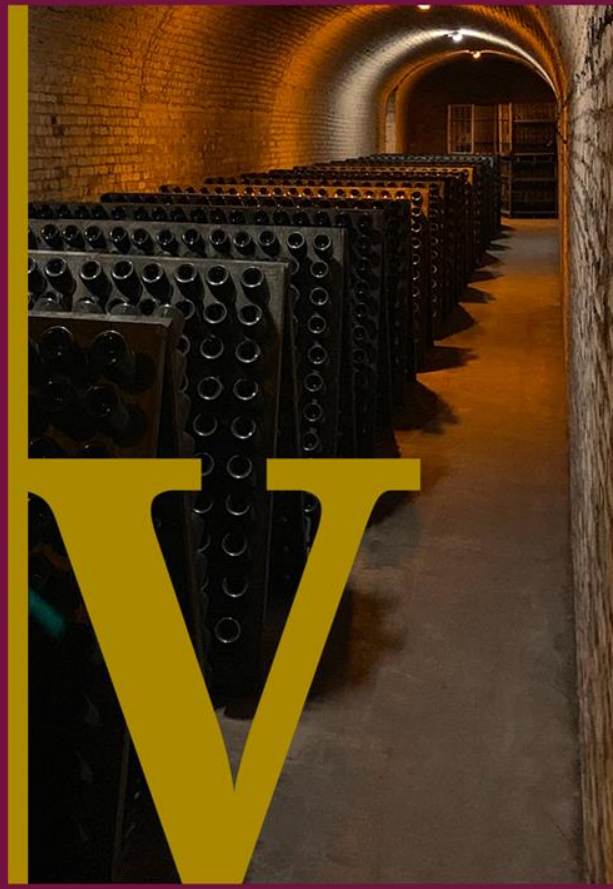
Vin Santo: Sweet wine from Tuscany made from late-harvest Trebbiano and Malvasia grapes.

Vineyards: A plantation of grapevines

Vinification: The conversion of grape juice into wine by fermentation. It is a term used to describe the winemaking process.

Vintage: A particular year in the wine business; a specific harvest.

Viticulture: The science and business of growing wine grapes.



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Weight: Similar to "body", the sensation when a wine feels thick or rich on the palate.

Wine: Alcoholic beverage made from fermented juice from grapes

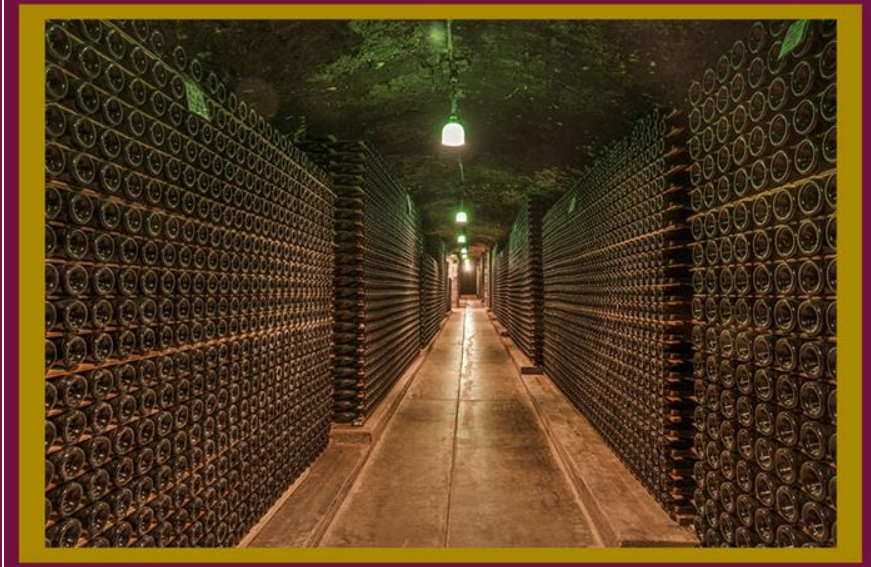
Wine cellar: A room for storing wine

Wine pairing: The technique of pairing food dishes with wine to enhance the dining experience.

Wine styles: A way to classify different types of wine based on many different factors or characteristics of the wine. The main wines styles are: red, white, rosé, sparkling, still, dessert and fortified wine.

Wine tasting: Sensory examination and evaluation of a wine.The main steps of the wine tasting process are visual, olfaction and taste analysis, and final conclusion.

Winery: A building or establishment where wine is made.



Wine Cellar

Yeast: Organisms that issue enzymes that trigger the fermentation process; yeasts can be natural or commercial.

Yield: The amount of grapes harvested in a particular year.

Young: An immature wine that is usually bottled and sold within a year of its vintage. Wines meant to be drunk "young" are noted for their fresh and crisp flavors.

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